

Question:

A 5-year-old boy is brought to the physician by his mother because he does not “listen to her” anymore. The mother also reports that her son cannot concentrate on any tasks lasting longer than just a few minutes. Teachers at his preschool report that the patient is more active compared to other preschoolers, frequently interrupts or bothers other children, and is very forgetful. Last year the patient was expelled from another preschool for hitting his teacher and his classmates when he did not get what he wanted and for being disruptive during classes. He was born at term via vaginal delivery and has been healthy except for 3 episodes of acute otitis media at the age of 2 years. He has met all developmental milestones. His mother has major depressive disorder and his father has Graves' disease. He appears healthy and well nourished. Examination shows that the patient does not seem to listen when spoken to directly. The remainder of the examination shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most appropriate next step in treatment?

Answer Choices:

- A. Behavior therapy
- B. Methimazole
- C. Fluoxetine
- D. Hearing aids

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms include difficulty in concentration , hyperactivity , and impulsivity , which are consistent with the characteristics of Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD). The behavior problems , such as interrupting or bothering other children and disruptive behavior during classes , further support this diagnosis . The patient's mother has major depressive disorder , which may contribute to the child's behavior problems , but it is not a direct cause of ADHD . Methimazole is used for Graves ' disease and would not treat ADHD . Fluoxetine is an SSRI (selective serotonin reuptake inhibitor) and can be used to treat ADHD , especially in cases where depression or anxiety is present . Behavior therapy , such as cognitive-behavioral therapy , can be effective for managing ADHD but is often used in conjunction with medication . Hearing aids are used to treat hearing loss and would not address the behavioral issues .

</think>

<answer> C . Fluoxetine </answer>